
Handout, Session 5: Market practice

Keep this page. It is your pocket guide for spending sats in the real world.

The five steps of a real purchase

1. Agree the price with the merchant, in [local currency].
2. Merchant shows a QR code or invoice for the amount.
3. Scan it with your wallet's "Send" screen.
4. Check the amount carefully.
5. Confirm, and watch it arrive on the merchant's phone.

Payments cannot be reversed, so always check before you confirm.

Finding merchants

- Many merchants show a QR code at the till, or use a simple wallet on their own phone.
- **BTCTMap.org** is an open map where shops that accept Bitcoin list themselves. Search your area to find them. [CONFIRM: what is listed near you.]
- A pilot session was run in Lomé, Togo, and partners work with a growing network of local merchants along the route.

Troubleshooting

- **No signal or slow data:** move to better signal, switch between wifi and mobile data, or wait and retry. Where there is no smartphone data, USSD options like Machankura exist. [CONFIRM availability.]
- **Wrong amount:** stop before confirming and ask for a fresh invoice.
- **Payment failed:** the sats stay with you. Try again, or ask for a new invoice. A failed payment is not a lost payment.
- **Merchant unsure it arrived:** show them your "sent" screen and ask them to refresh their wallet.
- **Scanning will not work:** ask the merchant to share the invoice text, or pay to a Lightning address.

Be a good guest

- Be patient and polite. Some merchants are new to this too.
- Keep your phone secure and do not block other customers.
- Thank the merchant.

Keep a simple record

Note what you bought, the amount in sats, and whether it went smoothly. This helps you and your facilitator learn what works in your area.

Reflection

- What did you buy, and how did it feel?
- What was smooth, and what was tricky?
- Where in your daily life would you use this again?

Remember

- Keep only everyday spending money on your phone.
- Your seed phrase stays on paper, never photographed, never typed into a website.
- This course gives no financial advice and makes no price predictions.

Glossary of terms: [../../../translations/GLOSSARY.md](#)